

[Lesson 26](#): “Go Ye into All the World, and Preach My Gospel” (See L26 [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To inspire us to follow the example of the faithful Kirtland Saints who made great sacrifices to share the gospel and who remained steadfast during times of adversity..

[An old suitcase](#) (See *Our Heritage*, 31)

† Historical Background

1. The Lord poured out great blessings during the Kirtland period.

Most “of the last 13 lessons have focused on the doctrines that were revealed and the events that occurred while the Saints were in Kirtland, Ohio. During this time, the Lord blessed His people greatly.” (*Lesson Manual*, 146)

What are some of the important doctrines the Lord revealed during the Kirtland period?

What were some of the important events and accomplishments during the Kirtland period?

† Events at Kirtland, Ohio

2. The Saints in Kirtland made great sacrifices to share the gospel.

• D&C 42:6; D&C 88:81. “And ye shall go forth in the power of my Spirit.” To “testify and warn the people”.

Our Heritage: “[Missions of Early Ohio Converts](#)”; “[Mission of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles](#)” (30-32)

†1. Milton V. Backman

†2. William C. Beardall

†3. William C. Beardall #2

†4. In April 1835, Parley P. Pratt

†5. Elder Parley P. Pratt, 1836

†6. John Taylor

What can we learn about missionary work from these stories?

What can we learn about overcoming adversity in missionary work?

What sacrifices may we need to make to serve as full-time missionaries?

How can we share the gospel with our friends and neighbors?

†7. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland

†8. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland #2

†9. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland #3

†10. Elder Richard L. Evans

3. Members of the Quorum of the Twelve taught thousands in England.

On 23 July 1837, the day the missionaries first preached the gospel in England, the Prophet Joseph Smith received a revelation directed to Thomas B. Marsh, the President of the Quorum of the Twelve. This revelation is now D&C 112.

Verses 12-34 contain instructions that Thomas B. Marsh was to give to the Twelve. The promise in [verse 19] was fulfilled quickly. Within eight months, 2,000 people had joined the Church through the efforts of these missionaries, and 26 branches had been organized. (*Lesson Manual*)

Our Heritage: “[Mission to England](#)” (32-33)

4. Many Saints in Kirtland remained valiant despite persecution.

Our Heritage: “[Exodus from Kirtland](#)” (36)

“While living in Kirtland, Brigham Young was in a meeting where a group of apostates, including some prominent Church leaders, were plotting to depose the Prophet Joseph Smith and put someone else in his place. Brigham Young said of this experience:

“I rose up, and in a plain and forcible manner told them that Joseph was a Prophet, and I knew it, and that they might rail and slander him as much as they pleased; they could not destroy the appointment of the Prophet of God, they could only destroy their own authority, cut the thread that bound them to the Prophet and to God, and sink themselves to hell. Many were highly enraged at my decided opposition to their measures.... This meeting was broken up without the apostates being able to unite on any decided measures of opposition.” (“History of Brigham Young,” *Deseret News*, 10 Feb. 1858, 386; in *Lesson Manual*)

What qualities did Brigham Young demonstrate in this situation?

How does sustaining our Church leaders strengthen the Church and us?

† LDS Institute D&C Student Manual quotes

Next Week: L27: “They Must Needs Be Chastened and Tried, even as Abraham”; See L27 [Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **Milton V. Backman:** “Shortly after joining the Church, Zera Pulsipher commenced missionary work. According to a family record, while working on his farm he felt impressed to leave home and begin preaching. The impulse was so strong that shortly before noon he unyoked his oxen and turned them into the pasture, then walked to the house and asked his wife for a clean shirt and a pair of socks.

“‘Where on earth are you going?’ She asked.

“‘I don’t know, only that I am going to preach the gospel. The Lord will show me where to go. I am going where He guides me.’

“‘How long will you be gone?’ she inquired.

“‘I don’t know. Just long enough to do the work the Lord has for me to do.’” (*The Heavens Resound*, 104; emphasis mine)

†2. **William C. Beardall:** “Brother Pulsipher began his missionary journey after lunch. He joined Elijah Cheney. Together they traveled to Richland, New York, where they held meetings in a school during the evening. They enjoyed success and soon organized a branch of the Church in Richland. Among those that were converted by the preaching of these brethren was Wilford Woodruff. He was baptized by Brother Pulsipher on December 31, 1833.” ([Gospel Doctrine Class Lesson 26](#))

†3. **William C. Beardall #2:** Wilford Woodruff “made his way to Kirtland in April 1834. A few days after meeting the Prophet, he joined Zion’s Camp on the march to Missouri. Brother Woodruff then served missions in the southern and eastern United States. In 1839, as a member of the Twelve, Brother Woodruff joined the second mission to England and was instrumental in the conversion of hundreds of Saints in Herefordshire.” (Gospel Doctrine Class)

†4. **In April 1835, Parley P. Pratt** was at home with his wife when Elder Heber C. Kimball and others came in to give him a blessing. In the blessing, it was prophesied: “Thou shalt go to Upper Canada, even to the city of Toronto, the capital, and there thou shalt find a people prepared for the fullness of the gospel, and they shall receive thee, and thou shalt organize the Church among them, and it shall spread thence into the regions round about, and many shall be brought to the knowledge of the truth and shall be filled with joy; and from the things growing out of this mission, shall the fullness of the gospel spread into England, and cause a great work to be done in that land.” (*Autobiography of Parley P. Pratt*, 110)

†5. **Parley needed to cross Lake Ontario**, but had no money to pay for steamer fare. “I retired to a secret place in a forest and prayed to the Lord for money to enable me to cross the lake. I then entered Hamilton and commenced to chat with some of the people. I had not tarried many minutes before I was accosted by a stranger, who inquired my name and where I was going. He also asked me if I did not want some money. I said yes. He then gave me ten dollars and a letter of introduction to John Taylor, of Toronto, where I arrived the same evening.” (*Autobiography of Parley P. Pratt*, 114)

†6. **John Taylor** was “a Methodist lay preacher in Toronto. Taylor was affiliated with a group who believed existing churches did not correspond with New Testament Christianity. For two years, this group had met several times a week for the ‘purpose of seeking truth, independent of any sectarian organization.’ In Toronto, Elder Pratt was courteously received by the Taylors, but they were not at first enthusiastic about his message.

“Discouraged at being unable to secure a place to preach, Parley decided to leave Toronto. Before going he stopped at the Taylors to get some of his luggage and to say goodbye. While he was there, Leonora Taylor told her friend Mrs. Isabella Walton about Parley’s problem and said she was sorry he was leaving. ‘He may be a man of God,’ she said. Mrs. Walton replied that she had been inspired by the Spirit to visit the Taylors that morning because she was willing to let Elder Pratt stay at her home and preach. He did so and was eventually invited to attend a meeting of John Taylor’s group, in which John read the New Testament account of Philip’s preaching in Samaria. ‘Now,’ said he, ‘where is our Philip? Where is our receiving the Word with joy, and being baptized *when we believed*? Where is our Peter and John? Our apostles? Where is our Holy Ghost by the laying on of hands?...’ When Parley was invited to speak, he declared that he had answers to John Taylor’s questions.

“For three weeks John Taylor attended Elder Pratt’s meetings, making detailed notes of his sermons and carefully comparing them with the scriptures. Gradually he became convinced that the true gospel of Jesus Christ was restored. He and his wife, Leonora, were baptized on 9 May 1836.” (*Church History in the Fulness of Times* [Church Educational System manual, 1993], 157; see also Parley P. Pratt, *Autobiography of Parley P. Pratt* [1975], 134-40, 151)

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Enrichment Resources:

†. **Historical Background:** Before he received this revelation, the Prophet Joseph Smith recorded in his journal that Kirtland was experiencing widespread disunity, contention, and apostasy. Financial speculation had caused the Kirtland Safety Society, the financial institution of the Church, to fail. Many, even some of the leaders of the Church, blamed the Prophet for such problems. The Prophet Joseph wrote: “In this state of things, and but a few weeks before the Twelve were expecting to meet in full quorum, (some of them having been absent for some time), God revealed to me that something new must be done for the salvation of His Church. And on or about the first of June, 1837, Heber C. Kimball, one of the Twelve, was set apart by the spirit of prophecy and revelation, prayer and laying on of hands, of the First Presidency, to preside over a mission to England, to be the first foreign mission of the Church of Christ in the last days.” (*History of the Church*, 2:489.)

President Joseph Fielding Smith wrote: “The day that the British Missionaries preached the first sermons in England, July 23, 1837, the Lord gave a revelation to the Prophet Joseph Smith directed to Thomas B. Marsh as president of the council of the apostles. In this revelation Elder Marsh was instructed to teach the brethren in his council and point out to them their duty and responsibilities in proclaiming the Gospel. Some of the apostles had forsaken their responsibility and had turned their attention to schemes of speculation.... The years preceding the year 1837, were years of wild speculation throughout the United States and Elder Heber C. Kimball pointed out how this boom had struck Kirtland and some of the brethren had borrowed great sums and had gone into business, at the expense of their ministry. Then when the bauble of false prosperity broke they were left financially stranded; then they began to blame the Prophet Joseph Smith. This revelation to Thomas B. Marsh was a warning and a call to him to bring his brethren back into the line of their duty as apostles of Jesus Christ.” (*Church History and Modern Revelation*, 2:71; see also *History of the Church*, 2:498-99.)

The first twelve verses of section 112 are directed to Thomas B. Marsh, giving him comfort, counsel, and admonition. The rest of the section contains the instructions he was to convey to the Twelve. (In *D&C Student Manual*, 279-280)

†. Events at Kirtland, Ohio:

1830

Fall: The gospel first preached in the Kirtland area by Oliver Cowdery, Peter Whitmer, Jr., Parley P. Pratt, and Ziba Peterson. Sidney Rigdon, Edward Partridge, and Frederick G. Williams were among the converts as a result of this missionary journey.

December: The Church commanded to gather in Ohio (D&C 37).

1831

January: Joseph Smith moves to Kirtland.

February: Edward Partridge called as first bishop of the Church (D&C 41).

February: The Lord revealed his law by which the Church was to be governed (D&C 42).

June: First High Priests ordained at a conference of the Church.

November: Preparations begun for the publication of the Book of Commandments.

1832

February: Joseph Smith and Sidney Rigdon - vision of the degrees of glory (D&C 76).

September: Revelation on the priesthood (D&C 84).

1833

January: School of the Prophets opened.

February: The Word of Wisdom revealed (D&C 89).

March: The First Presidency organized.

June: Work begins on the Kirtland Temple.

1834

February: Organization of the High Council (D&C 102).

May: Zion's Camp leaves Kirtland to aid the Missouri Saints.

1835

February: The Quorum of the Twelve organized.

February: The First Quorum of Seventy organized.

1836

March: The Kirtland Temple dedicated (D&C 109).

April: Important priesthood keys restored in the Kirtland Temple (D&C 110).

1837

June: Heber C. Kimball called to lead the first mission to England.

Note: In addition to those revelations noted above, Sections 1, 43-56, 63-75, 77-81, 85-88, 90-99, 101, 103-104, 106-108, 112, and 133 were also revealed in Ohio during this period. Most of Joseph's inspired revision of the Bible was done during the Kirtland period.

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Stories of Missionary Work:

Some ways we can be missionaries.

†7. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “A young returned missionary sister from Hong Kong told me recently that when she and her companion asked an investigator if she believed in God, the woman replied, ‘I didn’t until I met a member of your church and observed how she lived.’ What exemplary missionary work! Asking every member to be a missionary is not nearly as crucial as asking every member to be a member! Thank you for living the gospel

“Thank you also for praying for the missionaries.

Everyone prays for the missionaries. May it ever be so. In that same spirit, we should also pray for those who are (or who need to be) meeting the missionaries. In Zarahemla, members were commanded to “join in fasting and mighty prayer” for those who had not yet joined the Church of God. We can do the same.

“We can also pray daily for our own personal missionary experiences. Pray that under the divine management of such things, the missionary opportunity you want is already being prepared in the heart of someone who longs for and looks for what you have. “There are many yet on the earth ... who are only kept from the truth because they know not where to find it.” Pray that they will find you! And then be alert, because there are multitudes in your world who feel a famine in their lives, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the word of the Lord” (“[Witnesses Unto Me](#),” *Ensign*, May 2001, 16).

We can use our God-given talents to help others.

†8. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland #2:** “I had lunch recently with Elder and Sister John Hess of Ashton, Idaho. “We’re just old potato farmers,” John told me, but that is precisely what the nation of Belarus in the Russia Moscow Mission needed. For years the very best potato yields on government plots of ground there had been 50 sacks of potatoes a hectare. Considering it takes 22 sacks of seed to plant a hectare, the return was poor indeed. They needed help.

“Brother Hess asked for ground just three feet away from the government plots, rolled up his sleeves, and went to work with the same seed, tools, and fertilizer available in Belarus. Come harvest time they began to dig, then called on others to dig, then called on everyone to dig. With the same rainfall and soil, but with an extra measure of Idaho industry, experience, and prayer, the plots planted by the Hesses produced a whopping 550 sacks per hectare—11 times better than any prior yield on that land. At first no one would believe the difference. They wondered if secret teams had come in the night or if some wonder drug had been used. But it was none of that. Brother Hess said, “We needed a miracle, so we asked for one.” Now just little

more than a year later, in that community young proselyting missionaries are finding much more success just because an “old potato farmer” from Idaho answered the call of his church” (“[Witnesses Unto Me](#),” *Ensign*, May 2001, 16).

We can donate to Church missionary funds.

†9. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “I learned from a mission president recently that one of his young sister missionaries, nearing the end of her very faithful and successful mission, said through her tears that she must return home immediately. When he inquired as to the problem, she told him money had become so difficult for her family that to continue her support, the family had rented their home and were using the rental proceeds to pay her mission expenses. For living accommodations, they had moved into a storage locker. For water, they used a neighbor’s outdoor tap and hose; and for a bathroom they went to a nearby gasoline station. This family, in which the father had recently passed away, was so proud of their missionary and so independent in spirit that they had managed to keep this recent turn of events from most of their friends and virtually all of their Church leaders.

“When this situation was discovered, the family was restored to their home immediately. Long-term solutions to their economic circumstances were put in place, and the complete amount of remaining missionary support for their missionary daughter was secured overnight. With her tears dried and fears allayed, this faithful, hardworking young sister finished her mission triumphantly and was recently married in the temple to a wonderful young man” (“[Witnesses Unto Me](#),” *Ensign*, May 2001, 16).

10. **Elder Richard L. Evans:** “One of the most memorable missionary experiences happened to Elder Wilford Woodruff on the John Benbow farm in Herefordshire, England. He had been directed there by the Spirit early in 1840.

“When I arose to speak at Brother Benbow’s house, a man entered the door and informed me that he was a constable, and had been sent by the rector of the parish with a warrant to arrest me. I asked him, ‘For what crime?’ He said, ‘For preaching to the people.’ I told him that I, as well as the rector, had a license for preaching the gospel to the people, and that if he would take a chair I would wait upon him after the meeting. He took my chair and sat beside me. For an hour and a quarter I preached the first principles of the everlasting gospel. The power of God rested upon me, the spirit filled the house, and the people were convinced. At the close of the meeting I opened the door for baptism, and seven offered themselves. Among the number were four preachers and the constable. The latter arose and said, ‘Mr. Woodruff, I would like to be baptized.’ I told him I would like to baptize him. ...

“The first thirty days after my arrival in Herefordshire, I had baptized forty-five preachers and one hundred and sixty members of the United Brethren, who put into my hands one chapel and forty-five houses which were licensed according to law to preach in. This opened a wide field for labor, and enabled me to bring into the Church, through the blessings of God, over eighteen hundred souls [this number is given at a lower estimate in other accounts; it is approximate only] during eight months, including all of the six hundred United Brethren except one person” (“[History of the Church in Great Britain](#),” *Ensign*, Sep. 1971, 28).

LDS Institute D&C Student Manual:

D&C 112:10. How Important Is Humility in Church Positions? Humility is necessary for success in any Church position. Elder Harold B. Lee related: “I remember at a stake conference some years ago a young man was called to a high position. When we had asked him to express himself, expecting a humble testimony in his acceptance, he stood up and in a rather flamboyant, boastful way gave a dramatic performance. At the close of the service as we walked home, one of the high council whispered to me and said, calling him by name: ‘When he stood up there in the pulpit this morning, he was all alone.’” (In Conference Report, Oct. 1960, p. 17.)

President Thomas B. Marsh’s pride led to his eventual apostasy. His excommunication is a poignant reminder that the Lord has counseled his Saints to be humble. “Pride was the weakness of Thomas B. Marsh. If he had been humble, he would not have fallen. He began by defying the righteous decisions of the High Council and the First Presidency, in a trivial case in which his wife was interested, and he ended by [opposing] the Church.” (Smith and Sjodahl, Commentary, p. 733.)

Thomas B. Marsh eventually repented and was rebaptized. (In *D&C Student Manual*, 280)

D&C 112:11–12. A Charge to Pray for and to Admonish the Twelve: Smith and Sjodahl said: “Our Lord instructs the President of the Council to continue to pray for the members, and also to admonish them ‘sharply.’ Admonition without prayer is barren of results. He promised to feel after them, when they had passed through the tribulations awaiting them because they had yielded to temptations. And then, if they would not harden their hearts, they would be converted and healed.

“Orson Hyde, who had imbibed of the spirit of speculation, freely acknowledged his faults and asked forgiveness. Parley P. Pratt, too, at one time was

overcome by the evil spirit, of strife, but, he says, ‘I went to Brother Joseph Smith in tears, and with a broken heart and contrite spirit, confessed wherein I had erred. He frankly forgave me, prayed for me, blessed me.’ Others did not repent. Luke S. Johnson, Lyman E. Johnson, and John F. Boynton were rejected and disfellowshipped by the Church on the 3rd of September, 1837, less than a month and a half after this Revelation was given.” (Commentary, p. 734, in *D&C Student Manual*, 280–81)

D&C 112:24–26. “Upon My House Shall It Begin”:

In the same revelation in which Zion was defined, the Lord warned the Saints that only if Zion met the Lord’s qualifications would it escape the judgments that were to be poured out upon the world. If they did not qualify as a Zion people, they had no promise (see D&C 97:21–27). Severe judgments befell the Saints because they failed to build Zion and abide by its laws. This prophetic statement also had reference to future members of the Church.

President Brigham Young warned: “If the Latter-day Saints do not desist from running after the things of this world, and begin to reform and do the work the Father has given them to do, they will be found wanting, and they, too, will be swept away and counted as unprofitable servants” (in *Journal of Discourses*, 18:262).

President Joseph Fielding Smith pointed out: “All of these things will be withheld while the nations are being punished, if the members of the Church will keep faithfully their commandments. If they will not, then we have received the warning that we, like the rest of the world, shall suffer His wrath in justice.” (*Progress of Man*, p. 468.)

President Wilford Woodruff emphasized: “Zion is not going to be moved out of her place. The Lord will plead with her strong ones, and if she sins He will chastise her until she is purified before the Lord.

“I do not pretend to tell how much sorrow you or I are going to meet with before the coming of the Son of Man. That will depend upon our conduct.” (In *Millennial Star*, 2 Sept. 1889, p. 547. In *D&C Student Manual*, 282)

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